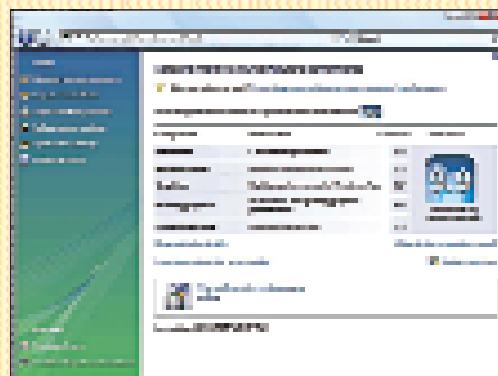


How would you modify your Experience Ratings in Windows Vista to reflect a higher performance?

Send in your solution with the subject "Take a Crack", and your postal address, to takeacrack@thinkdigit.com

Fake Your Vista Experience Rating

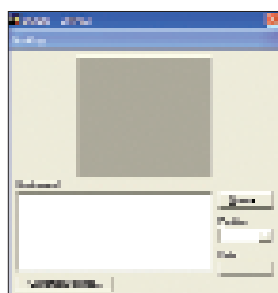


LAST MONTH'S CHALLENGE

Rearrange The Elements Of Your Desktop Settings

Solution To Last Month's Challenge

The method of making the cosmetic modifications to the Desktop Settings is by editing the Shell32.dll file, present in the SYSTEM32 directory (usually C:\Windows\System32). This file can be edited by Resource Hacker. Make sure that you backup the Shell32.dll file, because if something should go wrong, you may not be able to boot into Windows and will have to repair or reinstall it. Also make sure you exit any unwanted applications before you continue.



The original layout of the Desktop Properties window

Step 1: Download Resource Hacker from <http://www.soft32.com/download/63-59509/ResHack.zip>. Just extract it and open the ResHacker.exe file.

Step 2: Go to File > Open > C:\Windows\System32\shell32.dll

Step 3: Go to Dialog > 29952 > 1033

Step 4: In the right hand pane replace the text with the following.

```
29952 DIALOG 0, 0, 252, 218
STYLE DS_MODALFRAME | DS_NIDLEMSG |
WS_POPUP | WS_CAPTION
CAPTION "Desktop"
LANGUAGE LANG_ENGLISH,
SUBLANG_ENGLISH_US
FONT 8, "MS Shell Dlg"
{
    CONTROL "Background:", 30056,
    STATIC, SS_LEFT | WS_CHILD |
    WS_VISIBLE | WS_GROUP, 35, 1, 50, 8
    CONTROL "List Of backgrounds",
    30048, "SysListView32", LVS_REPORT |
    LVS_SINGLESEL | LVS_SHOWSELALWAYS |
    LVS_NOCOLUMNHEADER |
```

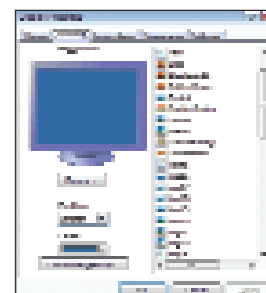
```
LVS_NOSORTHEADER | WS_CHILD |
WS_VISIBLE | WS_BORDER | WS_GROUP |
WS_TABSTOP, 131, 3, 119, 212
    CONTROL "&Browse...", 30049,
    BUTTON, BS_PUSHBUTTON | WS_CHILD |
    WS_VISIBLE | WS_GROUP | WS_TABSTOP,
    35, 122, 50, 14
    CONTROL "&Position:", 30055,
    STATIC, SS_LEFT | WS_CHILD |
    WS_VISIBLE | WS_GROUP, 37, 148, 50,
    8
    CONTROL "", 30051, COMBOBOX,
    CBS_DROPDOWNLIST | WS_CHILD |
    WS_VISIBLE | WS_VSCROLL |
    WS_TABSTOP, 37, 158, 50, 38
    CONTROL "&Color:", 30057, STATIC,
    SS_LEFT | WS_CHILD | WS_VISIBLE |
    WS_GROUP, 37, 177, 50, 8
    CONTROL "", 30054, BUTTON,
    BS_OWNERDRAW | WS_CHILD | WS_VISIBLE
    | WS_TABSTOP, 37, 187, 50, 13
    CONTROL "", 30053,
    "BackgroundPreview2", 0x50020000, 4,
    12, 125, 107
    CONTROL "Customize &Desktop...",
    30050, BUTTON, BS_PUSHBUTTON |
    WS_CHILD | WS_VISIBLE | WS_GROUP |
    WS_TABSTOP, 18, 200, 90, 14
}
```

Alternatively, you can just use the mouse to drag, place and resize the elements in the preview window to make the changes.

Step 5: Now click on Compile Script

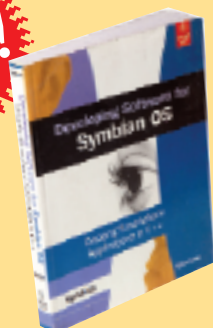
Step 6: Save and replace the file. You may be prompted to insert the Windows XP CD; ignore it. Close the Resource Hacker.

Step 7: Restart Windows. Open the Desktop Properties and you will see that the changes that you had made have taken effect. ■



The Display Properties window after modifications

Win!



Take a Crack and win

Developing Software for Symbian OS

by Steve Babin
Published by



LAST MONTH'S WINNER

Ankita Shalin Patna

Rules and Regulations

■ Readers are requested to send in their answers by the 15th of the month of publication.

■ Employees of Jasubhai Digital Media and their relatives are not permitted to participate in this contest.

■ Readers are encouraged to send their replies by e-mail. Jasubhai Digital Media will not entertain any unsolicited communication.

■ Jasubhai Digital Media is not responsible for any damage to your system that may be caused while you are trying to solve the problem.